

LED THROUGH EVERY VALLEY

A Dramatic Narrative based on Psalm 23

Performer: Timothy Rafael

School: Cherish Academy

Event: Platform Division — Expressive reading

Scripture: Psalm 23:1–4

Time Limit: 4 – 6 minutes

Note: Script must be memorised. Places will not be awarded if script is not memorised.

INTRODUCTION

(spoken before the narrative — does not count toward time)

*My name is Timothy Rafael, representing Cherish Academy.
The piece I will present today is titled "Led Through Every Valley,"
an original dramatic narrati based on Psalm 23,
written by Timothy Rafael.*

THE NARRATIVE

(Begin slowly. Calm, reflective tone. Look forward.)

There are moments in life...
when the path ahead feels unclear.

(pause)

Moments when you stand still —
unsure of where to go...
unsure of what comes next.

(softer)

You try to be strong.
You try to have all the answers.
But deep inside...
you feel lost.

(look slightly down, then back up)

Like a traveler without a map...
like a voice searching for direction in the silence.

(pause)

And in those moments...
fear begins to whisper.

(slightly tense tone)

"What if you fail?"
"What if you're alone?"
"What if you're not enough?"

(let it sit — then shift tone gently)

But then...
another voice speaks.

(clear, steady)

A quiet truth —
stronger than fear.

(with meaning)

***"The Lord is my shepherd...
I shall not want."***

(pause — let the words breathe)

A shepherd.

(gentle explanation tone)

One who leads...
when the way is uncertain.

(step slightly forward)

One who protects...
when danger is near.

(softer)

One who stays...
even when everyone else walks away.

(pause)

And suddenly...
I realize —

(more grounded tone)

I was never walking alone.

(transition — slightly brighter tone)

"He makes me lie down in green pastures..."

(slow, peaceful)

Not in chaos.

Not in fear.

But in peace.

(pause)

A place where my heart can rest...

where my thoughts grow quiet...

where I can breathe again.

(gentle)

"He leads me beside still waters..."

(flowing tone)

Not rushing.

Not forcing.

But gently guiding.

(pause)

Even when I don't understand the journey...

He does.

(shift to deeper emotion)

"He restores my soul..."

(hand to chest if appropriate)

Because sometimes...
it's not just the path that's broken —

(softer)

it's me.

(pause)

The exhaustion.
The doubt.
The silent struggles no one else sees.

(look up slowly)

And yet...
He restores.

(stronger)

Not with noise —
but with love.

(tone becomes serious, slower)

***"Even though I walk through the valley
of the shadow of death..."***

(pause — let it feel heavy)

The valley.

(quiet, intense)

The place we all fear.

(slowly)

The place of darkness...
of uncertainty...
of pain.

(pause)

A place where hope feels distant.

(look forward firmly)

But listen —

(clear, strong)

"I will fear no evil..."

(short pause)

Why?

(with conviction)

"For You are with me."

(let it land)

Not ahead of me.
Not far away.

(softer, powerful)

With me.

Psalm 23:1-4

Timothy Rafael | Cherish Academy | Accelerate Ministries Convention 2024